LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Arts and Humanities (History, Political Science, Psychology, Languages, Design, Media): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build reading, writing, speaking and curiosity about people and society; try debate, art, languages	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Explore interests (history, law, psychology, design, media, teaching); keep Standard Maths if possible	Keeps Economics Hons, Design (NID / NIFT) and other options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose Arts / Humanities subjects in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for CUET-UG, CLAT, UCEED, NID, NCET, liberal arts tests
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + the target entrance (CUET, CLAT, UCEED, NID DAT, NCET, college tests)	Merit seats and scholarships
Degree	After Class 12	BA, BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC, ITEP, Liberal Arts, BFA, Hotel Management	Professional or academic career
Postgraduate	3-5 years later	MA / MSc, MBA, LLM, M.Des, MSW, B.Ed, PhD	Specialist, teaching and research roles
Career	-	Civil services, law, psychology, media, design, teaching, research, hospitality	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: read widely, write, speak and observe. Join debate, quiz, art, drama, language and community activities.
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship test in Class 8; English / Social Science olympiads for exposure.†

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: keep Standard Maths in Class 10 (CBSE) if there is any chance of Economics, Psychology (Statistics), Design or a later change of stream.†
- NTSE (Class 10) covers Social Science and Mental Ability as well as Science and Maths.†

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose Arts / Humanities. Typical subjects: History, Political Science, Geography, Economics, Psychology, Sociology, Languages, Fine Arts, Home Science, Mass Communication.
- Add Mathematics or Statistics if you want Economics Hons, quantitative Psychology, or flexibility toward design technology. Karnataka PUC offers fixed combinations; confirm with the college.†
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: BA admission in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks.†

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- Apply in parallel: CUET-UG (central universities), CLAT (law), UCEED / NID DAT / NIFT (design), NCET (teaching), liberal arts tests (FLAME FEAT, Ashoka AAA, Azim Premji), SET / college tests.

After Class 12: Degree

- Academic: BA (History, Political Science, Economics, Sociology, Psychology, English, Kannada and other languages), 4-year honours / research options.
- Professional: BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC / BA Media, ITEP (BA B.Ed), Hotel Management (BSc), BFA, BSW.
- Liberal Arts at FLAME, Ashoka, Azim Premji, Krea and similar universities.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10 and beyond)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Timing (2026-27 cycle)
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10 (includes Social Science)	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign of discontinuation; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
English Olympiad (IEO) and similar	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†

Tip for parents: Humanities has few formal olympiads. Debate, MUN, quizzing, essay and art competitions, theatre, and school magazines build the profile that colleges and liberal arts universities look for.

4. Entrance exams after Class 10 / 12

UPSC Civil Services Examination (after graduation)	
Conducting body	Union Public Service Commission (UPSC); upsc.gov.in
Used for	IAS, IFS, IPS and other central services; IFoS prelims is taken in the same sitting
Eligibility	Graduation from a recognised university (final-year students may apply). Age: minimum 21; maximum 32 for General (relaxations for OBC, SC/ST, PwBD). Attempts: General 6, OBC 9, SC/ST unlimited (within age limit). Indian citizenship for IAS / IFS / IPS†
Frequency / dates	Once a year. CSE 2027 per UPSC calendar: notification 13 January 2027, applications close 2 February, Prelims 23 May 2027, Mains from 20 August 2027†
Pattern	Prelims: GS Paper 1 (100 questions, 200 marks, counts for merit) and CSAT Paper 2 (qualifying, 33%). Then Mains and Interview†
Karnataka	State civil services are held by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC)†

CUET-UG (for BA at central and other universities)	
Conducting body	NTA, cuet.nta.nic.in
Subjects	23 domain subjects including History, Political Science, Geography, Psychology, Sociology, Fine Arts, Mass Communication; mapping is set by each university and programme, often English + one or more domain subjects + General Aptitude Test†
Pattern / marking	Computer-based; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Frequency / month	Once a year; May-June†

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UCEED (Undergraduate Common Entrance Exam for Design) - IIT Bombay	
Conducting body	IIT Bombay; uceed.iitb.ac.in
Used for	B.Des at IITs (Bombay, Delhi, Guwahati, Hyderabad) and IIITDM Jabalpur†
Eligibility	Any stream. Class 12 (or equivalent) passed in 2026 or 2027 (first appeared in 2025 or earlier is not eligible). Born on or after 1 Oct 2002 (1 Oct 1997 for SC/ST/PwD)
Frequency / dates	Once a year; UCEED 2027 exam reported for 17 January 2027 (3 hours); registration reported 1-31 October 2026, though one source gives 21 October as the deadline†

NID DAT (National Institute of Design Design Aptitude Test)	
Conducting body	National Institute of Design (NID); admissions.nid.edu
Eligibility	B.Des: 10+2 from any recognised board; Maths recommended, all streams may apply; no upper age limit. Final Class 12 marksheet by 15 July 2027†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; applications reported 10 Sep - 30 Nov 2026, DAT Prelims 20 December 2026; sources disagree†
Pattern	Prelims, then Mains with studio tests and interview†

NIFT (National Institute of Fashion Technology)	
Conducting body	NIFT with NTA; nift.ac.in
Eligibility	B.Des: Class 12 in any stream. B.FTech: Mathematics required (Physics and Maths per one source). UG age: under 24 on 1 Aug 2027, 5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD†
Pattern	GAT (General Ability Test) and CAT (Creative Ability Test), then Situation Test / interview for some courses†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2027 dates not yet published†

NCET (National Common Entrance Test) - Integrated Teacher Education Programme (ITEP)	
Conducting body	NTA; exams.nta.nic.in/ncet
Used for	4-year integrated BA B.Ed / BSc B.Ed at about 223 institutions (about 16,950 seats reported)
Eligibility	Class 12 passed or appearing; minimum age 18 reported by one source†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam held 17-18 April, results 4 June 2026
Pattern	Computer-based, about 180 minutes: two languages (from 38), up to three domain subjects (from 26), teaching aptitude and a general test; MCQs with negative marking; 13 mediums. Question count reported as 181 (attempt 160)†

CTET and KARTET (teacher eligibility)	
Conducting body	CBSE (CTET, ctet.nic.in); Karnataka School Education Department (KARTET)
Eligibility	CTET Paper I (Classes 1-5): Class 12 with 50% + 2-year D.El.Ed or equivalent (4-year B.El.Ed also reported); Paper II (Classes 6-8): degree + B.Ed / equivalent†
Frequency / dates	CTET twice a year; February 2026 session on 7-8 February with re-exam for cancelled centres on 1 March; next session reported for 6 September 2026†. KARTET 2025 was held on 7 December 2025; 2026 notification not yet seen†
Pattern	CTET: offline OMR; 150 MCQs per paper, 150 marks, 2 hours 30 minutes, no negative marking; certificate validity reported as lifetime. KARTET: Paper 1 (Classes 1-5), Paper 2 (Classes 6-8)†

NCHM JEE (Hotel Management)	
Conducting body	NTA for the National Council for Hotel Management; exams.nta.nic.in/nchm-jee
Eligibility	10+2 with English; no age limit; appearing candidates can apply; no stream restriction stated (inferred)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 25 April (CBT, 120 cities)
Pattern	Computer-based; about 3 hours reported; section-wise breakdown not confirmed†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
CLAT	BA LLB / BBA LLB at National Law Universities	Class 12 pass, about 45% (40% SC/ST); 120 MCQs, 2 hr, +1 / -0.25; CLAT 2027 expected 6 Dec 2026, official notice not seen†. See Commerce document.
Liberal arts: FLAME FEAT or SAT / ACT	FLAME University	Online aptitude test (FEAT) plus essay, or SAT / ACT score with essay; final 2026 cycle test window reported 6-10 June†
Ashoka Aptitude Assessment (AAA) + On-the-Spot Essay	Ashoka University	Own test; SAT, ACT, CUET or JEE scores optional extras; no minimum percentage reported†
Azim Premji University National Entrance Test	BA / BSc programmes in Bengaluru	2026 intake test on 14 Dec 2025 with interviews 5-9 Jan 2026; age up to 21 on 31 July (exceptions possible)†
Krea University and other private universities	Liberal arts degrees	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
Media: SET, Christ University tests, CUET-UG	BA Mass Communication / Media Studies / Journalism	Symbiosis route via SET; Christ via own test + CUET per one source; IIMC admits to MA / PG diploma through CUET-PG only†
BA admission in Karnataka (BCU and other universities)	BA with chosen combinations	Mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12; no entrance exam for most colleges†
Fine and performing arts (BFA, music, dance, drama)	Visual and performing arts degrees	Entrance requirements not confirmed (for example Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath)†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CUET-PG	NTA	MA at central universities and IIMC MA programmes	Once a year†
UGC-NET	NTA	Lectureship, JRF in humanities subjects	Twice a year†
B.Ed / M.Ed entrance and teacher tests	Universities / states	School teaching	Varies†
CAT / XAT and other management tests	IIMs / others	MBA after BA	CAT: Nov†
TISS and other social work / policy entrance	TISS and others	MSW, development studies	Varies†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream (Humanities counts as its own stream); family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
University and foundation scholarships	Ashoka, FLAME, Azim Premji, others	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences, so Humanities students are generally not eligible for it.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
BA (History, Political Science, Sociology, Economics, Psychology, English, Kannada, Geography and other combinations)	3-4 yr	Merit in Karnataka; CUET-UG for central universities	Base for civil services, teaching, research, policy
BA Psychology, then MA / MSc Psychology	3-4 yr + 2 yr	Merit or CUET; PG entrance varies	RCI registration needed for clinical practice (see section 7)
BA LLB / BBA LLB	5 yr	CLAT and other law tests	See Commerce document
B.Des (IIT / NID / NIFT / private)	4 yr	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT	Product, communication, fashion, UX
BJMC / BA Mass Communication / Media Studies	3 yr	CUET, SET, college tests	Journalism, PR, digital media
ITEP (BA B.Ed)	4 yr	NCET	School teaching route
Liberal Arts (BA / BSc Hons, 3-4 yr)	3-4 yr	FEAT, AAA, Azim Premji NET, SAT / ACT	Interdisciplinary, research and policy
BSc Hospitality / Hotel Management	3-4 yr	NCHM JEE and college tests	Hotels, aviation hospitality, events
BFA / performing arts / BSW	3-4 yr	College entrance or portfolio†	Creative and social sectors

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): Delhi University and JNU (via CUET), Christ University, St Joseph's, Mount Carmel, Azim Premji University, Ashoka University, FLAME University, NLSIU Bengaluru (Law), IIT Bombay / IIT Delhi (B.Des), NID Bengaluru, NIFT Bengaluru, Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Civil services and public policy	IAS / IFS / IPS officer, state services, policy analyst, diplomat	UPSC / KPSC, MPP, MA Public Administration
Law	Lawyer, judge, legal advisor, human rights specialist	LLM, judicial services exams
Psychology and counselling	Counsellor, school psychologist, HR professional; clinical psychologist needs RCI registration and an RCI-approved clinical qualification (M.Phil vs RCI-approved MA is reported inconsistently; 4-year BA or 3+1 bridge also reported)†	MA / MSc Psychology, clinical qualification, PhD
Media and communication	Journalist, editor, content creator, PR and advertising professional	MA Mass Communication (IIMC via CUET-PG), PG diplomas
Design	Product, UX, graphic, fashion, communication designer	M.Des, MBA in design management
Teaching and education	School teacher (via CTET / KARTET), lecturer, education researcher	B.Ed, M.Ed, MA, UGC-NET, PhD

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Path	Job roles	Higher study
Research and academia	Historian, sociologist, economist, linguist, archaeologist, professor	MA, MPhil, PhD, UGC-NET
Hospitality, arts and social sector	Hotel and tourism manager, artist, performer, social worker, NGO leader	MSW, MBA, specialised diplomas

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

- Law: CLAT is open to Humanities students; BA LLB and judicial services are common routes.
- Management and Commerce: BBA, IPM and MBA accept Humanities graduates (see Commerce document); Economics Hons needs Maths in some universities.†
- Design and Technology: UCEED and NID accept all streams; UX, digital media and human-centred design combine Humanities with technology.
- Defence: NDA Army wing accepts any stream; Air Force and Navy need Physics and Maths.†
- Education: ITEP, B.Ed and TET exams lead to school teaching.
- Health and Social care: Psychology, social work, special education and counselling overlap with allied health.†

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Arts and Humanities

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Read, write, debate, create; Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Explore interests; keep Standard Maths if possible; NTSE (Class 10)
After Class 10	Choose Arts / Humanities subjects (History, Pol Sci, Psychology, Economics, Languages); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + CUET-UG; CLAT, UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NCET, FLAME / Ashoka / Azim Premji tests as targeted
After Class 12	BA, BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC, ITEP, Liberal Arts, Hotel Management, BFA; Civil services preparation can begin early
Postgraduate	MA, MSc Psychology, LLM, M.Des, B.Ed / M.Ed, MBA, UGC-NET, UPSC after graduation

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
UPSC CSE	Prelims May (2027: 23 May); after graduation	GS 200 marks + CSAT (qualifying 33%), then Mains, Interview	Negative marking in Prelims†
CUET-UG	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min	+5 / -1
CLAT	December (2027: expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr	+1 / -0.25
UCEED	January (2027: 17 Jan)	3 hours, any stream	Check brochure
NID DAT	Prelims Dec 2026†	Prelims then Mains / studio	Check brochure
NCET (ITEP)	April (2026: 17-18 April)	CBT, about 180 min; languages + domains + aptitude	MCQs with negative marking

Key rules: UPSC needs a graduation, age 21-32 (General), 6 attempts; BA in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC marks; UCEED, NID and NIFT B.Des accept all streams.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), CSSS (12,000/yr UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP, university scholarships.†

Careers: civil servant, lawyer, psychologist, journalist, designer, teacher, researcher, hospitality manager, artist, social worker.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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